TAN

BY RAHUL RAWAT AND SUHANI SINGH

TEAM INDIA'S 13-YEAR-LONG DRY SPELL at World Cup tournaments was broken in the early hours of June 30. Amidst the jubilation came the news of Rohit Sharma, 37, and Virat Kohli, 35, signing off from T20Is. A day later, Ravindra Jadeja joined them. With the loss of two talismanic batters, questions arose as to who takes the baton from them. Team India has two years to find the balance of power and precision when they defend the title on home turf. The dynamic Hardik Pandya and the invincible Jasprit Bumrah are dead certs for their spots; Suryakumar Yadav's magical versatility and Rishabh Pant's hunger to succeed will make them hard to replace. Nonetheless, fresh blood will also be infused and the Indian Premier League will be the usual hunting ground for selectors. By no means is this list of 15 players a definitive one. Batsmen like Shreyas Iyer, Ruturaj Gaikwad, Tilak Varma, wicket-keeper batsmen K.L. Rahul and Ishan Kishan, and bowlers like Sai Kishore can all find a way in. The Cup is ours, and with an embarrassment of talent in Generation Next, it may well continue to be ours.





GETTY IMAGES

JASPRIT BUMRAH, 30

Fast Bowler

T20 MATCHES: 70
WICKETS: 89, ECONOMY: 6.27

A gift that keeps giving generously. A "national treasure". For the past few years, Bumrah has demonstrated why he is deemed one of the best fast bowlers in the world across all formats. Watching Bumrah bowl his perfectly, but variably, pitched deliveries is to see poetry in fluid motion. His ability to perplex hapless, doubting batsmen with a few seconds of sublime craft makes him one of the most feared bowlers. At the T20 World Cup, he made his presence felt each time he rolled his arm—his 110 dot balls (out of 178) throttled teams chasing India's totals. Conceding just 124 runs in eight matches in what is a batsman-friendly format—a nearly impossible feat—only Bumrah could have been the Player of the Tournament.